



Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Data protection

- **Nzika Wallet controversy! Who holds the keys to Malawi's multibillion digital identity?** — Malawi24, 26 September 2026 MALAWI

A Malawi24 investigation reports that a Hong Kong-registered company won a US\$5.09 million World Bank-financed contract in March 2026 to supply 2,400 biometric registration kits to the National Registration Bureau, with remote software support. The procurement authority says remote access reaches the kits only; the bureau, the communications regulator and the supplier did not say who else can reach the identity system. *Also under [Digital Identity and CRVS](#) and [Data Storage](#).*

Regional collaboration

- **Gabon/Numérique : réunion préparatoire de la Conférence de plénipotentiaires de l'UIT (PP-26)** — AGP - Agence Gabonaise de Presse, 26 September 2026 GABON

Gabon's digital economy minister joined an African Union ministerial consultation in New York on ITU governance, preparing a high-level AU meeting in Libreville on 29 and 30 October 2026 on content regulation, satellite internet providers and infrastructure. Gabon is standing for a seat on the ITU Council, to be elected at the Plenipotentiary Conference in Doha from 9 November. *Also under [Standards](#).*

- **AfCFTA Digital Trade Rules Could Unlock Africa's \$700bn Digital Economy** — The High Street Journal, 26 September 2026 AFRICA

AfCFTA Secretary-General Wamkele Mene said in New York that Africa's digital economy could exceed US\$700 billion by 2035 if common rules on payments, data transfers and digital identity remove barriers between national markets. He pointed to the Protocol on Digital Trade and the eight annexes the African Union adopted in February 2025. *Also under [Data Exchange](#), [Digital Payments and Fintech](#) and [Digital Identity and CRVS](#).*

Standards

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Summarised under [Regional collaboration](#).

Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **Guessoum sur l'élaboration d'un décret sur l'interopérabilité numérique : «Permettre aux avancées numériques de produire pleinement leurs effets»** — Le Jeune Indépendant, 26 September 2026 ALGERIA

An Algerian business-federation head welcomed the presidential decree being drafted on a secure digital interoperability plan, arguing that administrations should verify information directly with each other rather than ask citizens and firms to resupply it. The decree was ordered by the Council of Ministers on 20 September 2026 and has not been published. *Also under [Data Exchange](#).*

- **Carte d'identité nationale en RDC : où en est le projet trois ans après la première carte remise à Félix Tshisekedi ?** — Lumière News, 26 September 2026 DRC

A Congolese civic group asked the government and the identification office on 24 September 2026 to account for the funds spent on the national identity card and to publish a delivery timetable, three years after the first card was handed to President Tshisekedi. It says he remains the only Congolese publicly issued one, and asks why mass enrolment has not reached provinces such as Tshopo. *Also under [Digital Identity and CRVS](#).*

- **Africa at the crossroads: Embracing AI for development without falling into dependency** — IOL, 26 September 2026 AFRICA

An opinion piece argues that African governments should adopt a pragmatic sovereign stance on artificial intelligence, using it for development while building their own compute, data governance, procurement and research capacity rather than importing foreign technology stacks and regulatory templates wholesale. *Also under [AI and Digital sovereignty](#).*

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **ASPEX 2026 : Le satellite au cœur des enjeux de connectivité et de résilience numérique en Côte d'Ivoire** — Afrik Soir, 26 September 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

At the Africa Space Expo in Abidjan on 25 September 2026, Côte d'Ivoire's telecoms regulator said three operators already sell satellite internet, two on geostationary satellites and one on a low-orbit constellation. It said it regulates them through a sandbox, periodic market analyses and the same consumer rights as terrestrial service. *Also under [Use of satellite data](#).*

Data Storage

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DPI

Data Exchange

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Digital Payments and Fintech

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Summarised under [Regional collaboration](#).

Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **Kenya targets \$750m industrial investment as Ruto uses UNGA to push economic diplomacy** — Capital FM Kenya, 26 September 2026 KENYA
Kenya signed a 2026-2030 country partnership programme with UNIDO at the UN General Assembly, linked to about US\$750 million in investment opportunities in industry, technology transfer and manufacturing. President Ruto also discussed an East African refinery and a regional office of the Africa Finance Corporation in Nairobi. *Also under AI.*

Technology

AI

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- **Africa at the crossroads: Embracing AI for development without falling into dependency** — IOL, 26 September 2026 AFRICA
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ICT Industry

- **Industrial Modernization Center Signs Cooperation Protocol with Corporate Stack Solutions to Boost Digital Transformation for SMEs** — Afronews, 26 September 2026 EGYPT
Egypt's Industrial Modernization Center agreed with a local software firm to move small and medium-sized factories onto locally built ERP and other applications on a monthly subscription, with the centre adding incentives and technical support. No price, number of factories or timetable was given. *Also under Innovation ecosystem.*

Innovation ecosystem

- **Startup Ecosystems Outside Lagos and Nairobi That Deserve More Attention** — TechTrends Africa, 26 September 2026 RWANDA UGANDA GHANA SENEGAL NIGERIA KENYA

A feature argues that African venture capital is spreading beyond Lagos and Nairobi, citing Startup Genome's 2026 ranking of eleven Sub-Saharan ecosystems from Lagos to Dar es Salaam. It puts first-quarter 2026 startup funding at US\$705 million across 59 deals in 14 countries, while Egypt, Nigeria, Kenya and South Africa still take the majority.

- **Finland lessons reshape Tanzania's startup and digital innovation agenda** — The Citizen (Mwananchi Communications), 26 September 2026 TANZANIA

A Tanzanian delegation from the ICT Commission, with officials and startups, spent a week studying Finland's innovation system under the EU-funded Digital for Tanzania twinning project. Its leaders said Tanzania needs reliable data on innovation and AI adoption and more domestic investment in startups.

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Data

Use of satellite data

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Geopolitics

Digital sovereignty

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ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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